

SEASONS

Drama

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Original Script

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2024-2026

FADE IN:

1. EXT. MOM'S FRONT PORCH

There are several bags and backpacks waiting alongside the staircase towards the front yard. The front porch is decorated with dying plants, and spring decor. ELIZABETH walks out the front door and tosses her stuff onto the porch, disregarding the items inside. Her MOM walks out behind her, concerned.

OTS OF MOM:

MOM

(sighing, frustrated)

Sweetie, you know this is dad's weekend. This cannot keep happening. You know I can't change the rules the court made. We agreed, you would go to dad's every other weekend.

Elizabeth glared at her mom. She just "doesn't get it."

ELIZABETH

(frustrated)

Mooommmmmmm, pleaseeeee? Last time it was dad's weekend, we had a big fight. It was ugly. Can you please let me stay here?

MOM sighs, and brushes Elizabeth's shoulder. Making Elizabeth feel a little better. She sighs, knowing she lost the argument. Elizabeth looks up at her mom, hoping her pleading eyes tell the story.

Her mother reassures her and gives her a warm smile. She wishes it didn't have to be this way. She despises her ex husband, wishing she was the sole provider for Elizabeth. She starts to head back inside when his car approaches the driveway. She turns and glances back at Elizabeth and pauses in the doorway.

CUT TO:

MEDIUM SHOT - MOM

MOM

(rolls eyes as dad pulls up, without Elizabeth seeing)

He's here. I love you honey. You'll be just fine. It's only a weekend, then you'll be right back here.

Elizabeth looks back over her shoulder.

ELIZABETH
(half smiles)
Yeah. Hope so. Love you, Mom.

She turns around to face the driveway, and as she turns her head we

CUT TO:

WIDE SHOT OF ELIZABETH FACING TWO PATHS ON EITHER SIDE OF THE SCREEN

Elizabeth walks from the front porch with her things, towards her DADS CAR. Its a run down, and sunburnt. Its been through the ringer. DAD is 50/M wearing the classic ball cap, grizzly beard, black t shirt, and jeans. He has the scent of cigarettes on his breath.

CUT TO:

MEDIUM SHOT OF DAD'S CAR WITH HIM STANDING BY THE CAR, HANDS IN HIS POCKETS

Elizabeth sets her things by the car, and stands in front of her dad. Both nervous to be the first to start a conversation.

There is a beat of silence. Elizabeth avoids eye contact with her dad, and he does the same. Worried to say the wrong thing.

DAD GIVES HER AN AWKWARD HUG

MATCH CUT TO:

OTS OF DAD

Dad gets out of the hug, leaving both hands on her shoulders.

DAD
Heeeyyy kiddo. How's my girl?

Elizabeth smiles warmly. She does love her dad, deep down, but doesn't know how best to show it for him. She SHRUGS and avoids eye contact.

ELIZABETH
(dry)
I'm alright. Where can I put my stuff?

DAD
Go ahead and toss 'em in the backseat. Then come sit in the front with me.

ELIZABETH
(looking away)
Okay. Thanks for picking me up.

She takes her things, and puts them in the car, taking her time to make sure she's got everything she needs. As she goes to CLOSE THE CAR DOOR, she glances over her shoulder one last time. She LOOKS BACK AT THE HOUSE. She shuts the rear car door

MATCH CUT ON DOOR CLOSE:

2. INT. DAD'S CAR

The car hasn't even started yet and both Elizabeth and Dad feel as though they have never spoken. Neither try to look at each other, nor do they want to break the ice and say something that'll make it awkward. So they just sit in silence for a beat.

DAD
(quiet, reserved)
So... What's been going on in your world? What's my favorite daughter into these days?

They both continue staring at the road, while Elizabeth stares out the passenger seat window. She keeps her hands busy and avoids even promoting any body language of affection towards her dad.

ELIZABETH
Nothing.

There is a beat of silence, as the road swallows their time. Dad looks at his daughter, wanting more from her, but gives in. He TURNS THE KEY to start the car and they start driving AWAY FROM THE HOUSE.

MS ELIZABETH LOOKING OUT THE WINDOW

CAR DRIVING OFF THROUGH THE NEIGHBORHOOD

FADE TO BLACK:

3. INT. DAD'S CAR

WIDE SHOT from the backseat

MEDIUM SHOT - DAD'S EYES IN REAR VIEW MIRROR

MEDIUM SHOT - Elizabeth in the passenger window reflection

DAD
(nervous, but
enthusiastic)
Hey Lizzie, remember when-

ELIZABETH
(disgusted)
Daaaad! I hate when you call me
that. You've used that since I was
like, five.

Elizabeth sighs and continues to look out her window as Dad
mouths "oops" under his breath. He tries again.

DAD
Ohhhkay.

There's a beat of silence. He tries a different approach as
she continues to stare out her window.

DAD
I got that Beatles CD you used in
middle school. That scratched up
one. We could give that another go?

Elizabeth rolls her eyes -- but covers a small smile with her
hand. She doesn't show it, but she is suprised how long he's
held onto that CD.

DAD and ELIZABETH continue driving for a while and eventually
they find a familiar street. Elizabeth sits up a small bit,
realising where they are. She didn't even realise she didn't
ask where they were going.

ELIZABETH
(slightly shocked, giddy)
OH my gosh. This is still here?

DAD
Well, of course. It's a road. It's
only your favorite nature trail
you've loved since you were little.
I thought we'd give it a try, since
its been so long. Whaddya say?

Elizabeth rolls her eyes as he has delivered yet another dad
joke. How does he have so many?

Her and dad exchange a glance at each other, and they both
look away to look at the ground and smile lightly. Maybe this
time together isn't so bad.

There seems to be a small lift of tension in the air as the
laughter softly ceases from the car.

DAD

I'll take that, as a yes. If I weren't mistaken, I'd say I just saw you smile for the first time since I last saw you.

ELIZABETH

(chuckling)

Heheh. Yeah.

They hop out of the car and step onto the gravel parking lot and head towards the canopy of trees.

CUT TO:

4. EXT. NATURE TRAIL - DAY

Nature trail pathways, with blooming trees surrounding the two of them. They are deep into the trail walk, taking with the nature around them and the peace of the surrounding birdsong.

Dad and Elizabeth are WALKING ALONG THE TRAIL, DAD stops to pick up a ROCK. He holds it in his hand for a minute before finding the courage to try saying something to her.

DAD

Remember when we set all the rocks you found up on the window ledge? You used to say they all had a story.

Elizabeth looks back at her dad, scoffing at the distant memory. That was so long ago now. Why would he still care about something like that?

DAD smirks with a laugh and tosses the rock back onto the ground. We FOCUS ON THE ROCK AS THEY CONTINUE DOWN THE TRAIL. Leaving it in the past.

The two of them continue down the trail for a while and eventually reach a bench. Needing a break, they both decide to sit down. DAD approaches the bench ahead of Elizabeth. They BOTH SIT DOWN, keeping their distance.

There is a beat of silence as they sit together.

DAD

I heard about the rejection letter from school.

Elizabeth recalls how angry she felt then. She crosses her arms and scoffs.

ELIZABETH

(frustrated, sharp)

Yeah. Thanks for the reminder, DAD.
I didn't get in, whoopdeedo. You
happy now?

DAD

(shocked, reassuring)

Heyyy now. That's no way to speak
to your old man. I'm sure there are
tons of places that are still
looking for someone like you.

ELIZABETH

Dad- Just... Stop. You don't know
how hard it is to apply for school
like this. You never even went to
college.

DAD

(realization)

Oh. Do you think I was born
yesterday? I know I dont look like
I've done much, but I've had my
fair share of education back in the
day.

Elizabeth then gives her dad eye contact. Shocked that he has
even an ounce of knowledge about an education. He seriously
had a life before this family?

ELIZABETH

What- what do you mean? You were in
school?

DAD

Oh yeah. I applied to loads of
different schools. Some of 'em even
offered me a full scholarship to
play music for them. Remember that
old guitar in the basement?

Elizabeth gasps. She does remember that guitar. It has
collected dust in the storage unit for several years now. He
has yet to pick it up.

ELIZABETH

(suprised)

Dad, oh my gosh!! I never knew that
was your guitar?

DAD

Oh yeah! That's the only one I have
left now. Had to sell my other ones
to try and get some money back.

Elizbeth realises how much life has been taken from her dad
in this moment.

There is a beat of silence as they take in the scenery around them again. Taking a new perspective on what her dad has gone through. She looks up at him as they continue to sit on the bench. He doesn't notice her stare.

Suddenly, DAD FEELS HER STARE AND LOOKS TOWARDS ELIZABETH, she has tears in her eyes.

DAD
(soft, gentle)
Honey? What is it?

Elizabeth is moments away from breaking. She does not yet cry. We see her go through all the things she can't say, as if there is a wall between her words, and the open air. She feels trapped, yet eager to tell her father all that she has been struggling with.

DAD SEES THIS

CUT TO:

WIDE SHOT of the two of them facing away from camera

There is a beat of silence as they sit together. DAD waiting patiently for his daughter to find the right words. He is in no rush to get her to speak on anything she's not ready for.

MS - Elizabeth

Elizabeth LOOKS UP TOWARDS HER DAD, in tears still. Lip slightly open, she sees her dad as if for the first time.

ELIZABETH
(emotional, teary-eyed)
Dad, I... I don't know what to say.
I feel like I've failed. Like I'm
running from the life that I have,
yet I'm always pushing the people I
love most away in order to achieve
the life I want. I've always felt
trapped in this house, like my
whole life will be stuck in this
stupid neighborhood.

DAD
(soft, fatherly)
Oh sweetheart. Don't say that to
yourself. I know what it's like to
feel lost, trust me.

They reciprocate a look to each other as the word "lost" escapes her dad's lips. Elizabeth looks down and continues.

ELIZABETH
It's like I'm lying to myself
daily.
(MORE)

ELIZABETH (CONT'D)

I don't know what else to do. Why-
Why is it all up to me? I can't
even get good grades anymore. I'm
failing in school, I have no desire
to do anything anymore.

DAD

No... No, no no Lizzie. Don't give
up on yourself. You have so much
life ahead of you, and so many good
things waiting for you. You have a
family, a team! Hell, you have me.

DAD feels nervous as he says these last three words. His eyes
widen as he realizes he's offering himself to his daughter
for the first time in many years. Questioning if he can truly
fill this role for her.

ELIZABETH

(breaking)

But, I didn't get accepted. It's
over. That was my one shot at life,
and its gone.

DAD

I know it seems like your life has
ended before it's even started.
But... Even if you can't see the
trail ahead, I know there will be a
crossroads. All those decisions may
look scary, but no matter what you
choose, I'll hold your hand through
all of it, dear.

ELIZABETH

(sniffles, then takes a
deep breath)

What if I fail? Ever since I got
that letter, I've just given up.
Like nothing else matters to me
now. How am I supposed to come back
from this?

DAD

I've seen you do a million
different things in my years of
being your father, honey. You've
climbed dirt piles when you
pretended to be a ninja, you've
rode horses, you have even went out
for cross country! What could
possibly stand in your way? You
have the whole world ahead of you.
There is nothing Lizzie can't do.

With those last words, DAD PUTS HIS HAND ON HER SHOULDER. He rubs her shoulder, hoping that his words sank in the right way. Maybe this is enough to build something back up. Maybe this will be the fresh start he's been hoping for.

MEDIUM SHOT - Dad and Elizabeth sitting together, looking at each other. Closer in distance.

Elizabeth responds to his touch and takes in the space around her. She puts her hand on top of his, and they face each other. Elizabeth feels the walls around her start to crumble.

There is a small beat of silence where they look at each other. They both smile at each other again, but this time, the smiles come from the inside. There is a breath of peace in the air.

ELIZABETH

Dad?

DAD

Yes?

ELIZABETH

I love you. I'm sorry I haven't said it in a while.

DAD

(eyes widen, then softens)

I love you too, honey.

They both hug each other for a long beat. A tear is shed. The moment is wrapped in birdsong and the rustling of the leaves, as if the world around them is shaking off the years of dust the two of them have had. Here is a fresh start.

DAD and ELIZABETH now walk back the same way they came, this time, holding hands. DAD takes off his cap and smashes it onto Elizabeth's head. We hear distant laughter.

CAMERA STAYS ON THE BENCH, planted in the memory of new beginnings.

PAN UP FROM BENCH TO TREE TOPS, WIND RUSTLING FOR A BEAT

CUT TO BLACK:

END